

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 994

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A RESOLUTION to recognize and congratulate the Tennessee Black Caucus of State Legislators Living Legend Award honorees, Reverend Ann Jones-Pierre, Dr. Carolyn Baldwin Tucker, and Representative Johnny Shaw.

WHEREAS, it is most appropriate that the members of this General Assembly should honor those estimable individuals who have dedicated their time and energies to providing thoughtful and exemplary service to their fellow citizens during their lifetimes; and

WHEREAS, the Tennessee Black Caucus of State Legislators has honored three individuals this year with its Living Legend Award in recognition of their outstanding contributions to their communities and this State; and

WHEREAS, this year's honorees are Reverend Ann Jones-Pierre, Dr. Carolyn Baldwin Tucker, and Representative Johnny Shaw; and

WHEREAS, these individuals are most deserving of recognition as "Living Legends," as they have all made important, indelible contributions during their decades of public service; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Ann Jones-Pierre has been active in ministry for four decades, during which time she has held various positions of leadership and influence; she is also retired from the Tennessee Valley Authority, where she served as a senior manager in finance; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Jones-Pierre served as CEO of Church Koinonia Federal Credit Union for thirteen years and currently continues the fight for justice and economic equality as president of the Chattanooga Branch of the NAACP, of which she is a Diamond Life member; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Carolyn Baldwin Tucker is a longtime educator and administrator who was employed with Metro Nashville Public Schools for thirty years—as a classroom teacher, principal, and, ultimately, elementary schools director; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Tucker's influence extended to her service as a visiting professor at Lipscomb University and as Lipscomb's Director of Graduate Studies in Education, as well as her roles as an Exemplary Educator for the Department of Education and a member of Nashville's Metro Council; and

WHEREAS, Representative Johnny Shaw has served the people of Hardeman and Madison counties as the State Representative of House District 80 since January 2001; he previously served as a Madison County Commissioner and, alongside his wife, founded the Shaw Broadcasting Company, LLC, and established WOJG-FM in Bolivar in 1992; and

WHEREAS, Representative Shaw was called to preach the gospel and later became the Under Shepherd for Saint John Missionary Baptist Church, where he continues to serve the congregation; he is a lifetime member of the NAACP and has served as a board member of the National Civil Rights Museum; and

WHEREAS, the unwavering dedication to serving others exhibited by these exceptional individuals will continue to inspire others for generations to come; and

WHEREAS, it is most fitting that we recognize these exemplary Tennesseans on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we recognize and congratulate the Tennessee Black Caucus of State Legislators Living Legend Award honorees, Reverend Ann Jones-Pierre, Dr. Carolyn Baldwin Tucker, and Representative Johnny Shaw, salute their continuing legacies as community leaders, and extend to them our best wishes for much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.